VIT BHOPAL

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<u>Introduction</u>:

Project Overview and Scenario

You have just been appointed as a Student Digital Ambassador, and the first task assigned to you is to develop a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, which will help guide your peers through the complexities of the modern online world. As a Student Digital Ambassador, you will help guide others in creating professional online profiles and engaging in safe and responsible forms of digital communication.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, you will need to complete five separate tasks, one for each module, which will include everything from visual design and professional networking to coding and cybercrime. Your progress will need to be recorded in a structured GitHub repository, which is not only a means of submitting the assignment but also a permanent part of the professional digital identity. The final assignment will require a detailed report, where you will need to write about the tools, the challenges, and the habits that are essential for safe and professional digital communication.

Task 1:

Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I created a professional one-page infographic titled "Navigating the Digital Frontier" using Canva. The infographic is created particularly for my peers and focuses on three major pillars of digital literacy awareness, which are defining what it means to be digitally literate, digital tools that are beneficial for engineering students, and safe internet use. It has a modern look with clear sections and icons to ensure it is scannable and interesting for a student audience.

The creation of this infographic was also a very rewarding task, especially because it helped me distill complex ideas into simple, actionable points. One thing I found particularly fascinating was the opportunity to dig through Canva's extensive selection of design elements to find the right icons to represent abstract concepts such as "safe internet practices". Though it was slightly difficult to find the right color palette for the infographic without compromising professionalism, the overall design was quite seamless.

Task 2:

Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For the second task, I created a professional online presence by creating profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow. The reason behind this is that these platforms represent primary online interfaces for employers and the global tech community. In this regard, my GitHub profile was customized with a unique README describing my branch and learning objectives, while my LinkedIn profile was updated with the current degree and institution attended at VIT Bhopal.

The aim of these platforms is to present my technical projects, network with other technical professionals in the field, and be part of the problem-solving community. In the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a personal platform to present my coding journey, LinkedIn to keep up to date with internship and placement opportunities, and Stack Overflow to be part of the coding community and learn from other members. I plan to maintain these platforms to develop a credible and competitive digital identity in the next four years in the tech industry.

Task 3:

Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

In Task 3, I used HackerRank for coding practice and Google Forms for cloud-based collaboration. For HackerRank, I used the platform to practice the basics of problem-solving through the 'Solve Me First' challenge and the Python Introduction course. I added screenshots of completed challenges and badges to my repository as I progressed through the tasks.

In addition to that, I also created a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using Google Forms. This is an interactive tool that has exactly five questions for assessing the knowledge of my peers regarding online safety and digital tools. These tools are critical for my academic journey since they are going to help me in building the much-needed infrastructure for developing the needed technical knowledge and teamwork for effective collaboration in the near future.

Task 4:

Professional Email & Etiquette

In this task, I learned through a hypothetical scenario of a student who did not get a response for an internship due to an unprofessional subject heading and greeting. The hypothetical scenario taught me the consequences of bad digital communication and how it can cost you opportunities and your professional image. I learned to write formal emails for an assignment extension and an internship application.

What I learned from this guide is that professional digital etiquette is not based on the length of the email but on clarity and the quality of subject headings and greetings used. I also learned to create a "Social Media Do’s and Don’ts" checklist to guide me in ensuring I maintain a responsible and professional image as a college student. It is essential to learn these communication skills to gain the trust of professors and future employees.

Task 5:

Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

While researching the mechanism of Phishing and UPI fraud for this assignment, I have to say it was a rather sobering experience. The most surprising aspect was the sophistication of social engineering attacks targeting college-going youth; I thought only people who are tech-illiterate fall prey to such crimes, but it seems even tech-savvy people like me are not immune to such tactics.

One thing I have decided to change personally because of this assignment is the way I use MFA and link verification. I have decided to never click on "urgent" transaction links that come via SMS or WhatsApp without verifying them via official apps when it comes to UPI/Online Payment safety. I have also saved the National Cybercrime Helpline Number "1930" and the portal "cybercrime.gov.in" in my contact list so that in case of any such crime happening to myself or someone I know, I am prepared to take immediate action.

Conclusion:

Overall Learning

The journey as a Student Digital Ambassador has been transformative, bridging the gap from the basic knowledge of internet usage to professional digital citizenship. Throughout the five modules of the project, I have transitioned from being a mere consumer of technology to becoming an active and responsible contributor to the digital world.

Key takeaways from this experience include:

Professional Identity: I learned that having a digital identity online, like on LinkedIn and GitHub, is like having a dynamic portfolio that needs constant maintenance in order to showcase my developing expertise.

Effective Communication: I mastered the art of professional communication, knowing that proper etiquette in emails is just as important as the content they carry.

Digital Resilience: In studying cybercrime, I learned the importance of having safety protocols, like UPI security, and the need to use official reporting channels like 1930.

Collaboration: In using cloud-based tools like Google Workspace, I learned how having proper digital literacy can help me work effectively and efficiently in academics.

Overall, this project has provided me with a basic "Digital Literacy Portfolio" that will form the bedrock of my academic and professional success.

References:

Task 1: Canva.

Task 2: LinkedIn, GitHub, Stack overflow,

Task 3: Hacker rank, Google forms.

Task 4: Gmail, Google word

Task 5: National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, Cyber Crime Helpline (1930)

Academic Platform: **VITyarthi E-Learning Platform**

Additionally: Gemini, ChatGPT, YouTube